

KINGPIN

Bulky criminal mastermind

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FACTFILE

REAL NAME

Wilson Grant Fisk

OCCUPATION

Criminal mastermind

BASE

New York City

HEIGHT 6 ft 7 in

WEIGHT 450 lbs

EYES Blue

HAIR None

FIRST APPEARANCE

Amazing Spider-Man Vol 1 #50
(July 1967)

POWERS

Brilliant criminal mind and superb fighting skills; his body, though huge and heavy, is composed of almost solid muscle.



Fisk was so in love with the beautiful Vanessa that he agreed to renounce his criminal ways—until fate took a hand.



Sabotage by various costumed crimefighters has hobbled the Kingpin's illicit empire.

The Kingpin's son, Richard Fisk, became a rival to his father as the masked Rose.



Wilson Fisk, the Kingpin, is the most formidable figure in organized crime, and a perennial enemy of the Super Heroes SPIDER-MAN, the PUNISHER, and, most frequently, DAREDEVIL. The Kingpin's operations are global and the assassins that have done his dirty work are legion, including such names as BULLSEYE, ELEKTRA, and TYPHOID MARY.

UNDERWORLD KING

As a youth, Fisk bulked up his body to strike back against the bullies who tormented him, committing his first murder at the age of 12. At 15, he led a gang of street toughs, and came to be called the "Kingpin of Crime." Employed by crimelord Don Rigoletto, he ended up killing Rigoletto and assuming control of his operation. He married Vanessa, a beautiful socialite, and they had a son, Richard. The Kingpin also became the guardian of Maya Lopez (ECHO), the daughter of one of his murdered business partners. After decades in power, the Kingpin organized the various New York gangs and challenged the MAGGIA, triggering a war that Spider-Man helped to end.

POWER STRUGGLES

The Kingpin believed that his son Richard had died in a skiing accident. In truth, Richard had become a rival crimelord, the SCHEMER, who lured his father into an alliance with a HYDRA faction. The Kingpin left his empire behind to pursue a new life with Vanessa in Japan, but returned with a vengeance after Vanessa's apparent death. Richard Fisk then became a new criminal rival, the ROSE.

After the Kingpin learned Daredevil's secret identity, he set out to destroy the hero's life. The Kingpin's empire crumbled under assault from HYDRA. He rebuilt his empire, but his foster daughter Echo blinded him by shooting him in the face, and the Kingpin's inner circle—including his son Richard—stabbed him many times and left him for dead. Vanessa nursed her husband back to health, and killed Richard for betraying his father.

Imprisoned, the Kingpin continued to scheme from behind bars. He exposed Daredevil's secret identity and caused him to be arrested. Also, after Spider-Man revealed his true name, the Kingpin ordered a hit that nearly killed MAY PARKER instead. His secret later restored, Daredevil helped the Kingpin win his trial in exchange for leaving the country. He recently returned

to exact vengeance on the Hand, which would not leave him be. **DW, MF**



Sheer muscle mass makes the Kingpin surprisingly strong and tough, allowing him to withstand Spider-Man's powerful blows.

ESSENTIAL STORYLINES

• Daredevil Vol. 1 #227-233

In the acclaimed "Born Again" story arc, the Kingpin's malicious schemes bring Daredevil to the edge of a mental breakdown.

• Daredevil Vol. 2 #46-50

In a shocking turn of events, Daredevil defeats the Kingpin and takes over as boss of New York City's notorious Hell's Kitchen.